

represented 58 percent of the 2.6 million mobile devices purchased by U.S. schools and about 64 percent of that market outside the U.S. By contrast, sales of Apple tablets and laptops to U.S. schools dropped that year to 19 percent, compared with 52 percent in 2012. According to a US IDC Analyst, in Q1 2016 Chrome OS (then only on Chromebooks) overtook Mac OS for the first time – all with the power of K-12 sales behind them. They also made great sense for businesses that had limited use for a full-fledged laptop.

Chromebook Pixel

When Google introduced the first Chromebook Pixel, it was clearly meant to show manufacturers what a Chromebook could be capable of. While the \$1,000 pricing drew some flak for the limited capabilities of a Chromebook, the motto behind the design really was ‘What could we (Google engineers) do if we really wanted to design the best computer possible at the best price possible?’

The initial model had some really good specs to boast of. For starters, the display had the highest pixel density in a laptop, along with touchscreen capabilities - something that was (and has been) missing from the similarly priced Macbooks. In fact, it



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wouldn't be too wrong to say that the display was the USP of the device. It sported an uncommon 3:2 ratio in dimensions, something that leads to more vertical space for experiencing the web. And considering how much work on a Chromebook was to be done on a browser, this was a good design change on the part of Google.

While the initial model was restricted to Wi-Fi, a subsequent version launched the same year added LTE support. And beyond that, a couple of models launched in 2015 brought the hardware to a new level with more RAM, better processors, and higher storage options at launch. Overall, it was a good device – perhaps too good for what it could do.

As Linus Torvalds put it, the screen on the Pixel was praiseworthy but not the operating system, which he felt was better suited to slower hardware.